Part A – Short Essay

(Answer any 10 – 2 marks each)

1. Define Polyandry

Polyandry is a form of marriage in which one woman has more than one husband at the same time. It is found in certain tribal and traditional societies.

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2. Explain Gender Socialization

Gender socialization is the process through which individuals learn gender roles, behaviours, attitudes, and expectations accepted by society. Family, school, peer groups, religion, and media play important roles in this process.

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3. Explain Competition

Competition is a social process in which individuals or groups strive to achieve the same goal, status, or resource that cannot be shared equally. It may be economic, educational, or political.

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4. Social Inequality

Social inequality refers to unequal distribution of wealth, opportunities, power, and social status among individuals or groups in society based on class, caste, gender, race, etc.

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5. Define Organization

An organization is a structured group of people working together to achieve common goals through coordinated activities and established rules.

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6. Explain Social Category and Social Aggregate with Example

A social category is a collection of people sharing common characteristics but lacking interaction, such as “teachers” or “women.”
A social aggregate refers to people gathered in the same place without meaningful interaction, such as passengers waiting at a railway station.

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7. Define Culture

Culture refers to the total way of life of a society including beliefs, values, customs, language, norms, art, and material objects transmitted from one generation to another.

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8. Define "Unfocused Interaction"

Unfocused interaction refers to casual and indirect social interaction occurring when people are merely aware of one another's presence without direct communication.

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9. Relationship between Types of Social Action and Agency

Max Weber's types of social action explain how individuals act based on meanings, values, emotions, or traditions. These actions reflect human agency because individuals consciously make choices and influence social life.

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10. Norms

Norms are socially accepted rules or standards that guide and regulate human behaviour in society.

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11. Define Capitalism

Capitalism is an economic system characterized by private ownership of property and means of production, profit motive, market competition, and wage labour.

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12. Define Adult Socialization

Adult socialization is the process through which adults learn new roles, values, and behaviours required for changing social situations such as marriage, employment, or parenthood.

Part B – Short Essay Questions

(Answer any 4 – 5 marks each)

13. Can people cooperate even if they do not fully agree on everything? Explain briefly.

Yes, people can cooperate even without complete agreement because cooperation is often based on common interests or shared goals. In society, individuals and groups may differ in opinions, beliefs, or values but still work together for mutual benefit.

For example, political parties may cooperate in a coalition government despite ideological differences. Similarly, workers in an organization cooperate to complete tasks even if they disagree personally.

Sociologists view cooperation as an essential social process that promotes social order, integration, and collective survival. Mutual tolerance, compromise, and communication help maintain cooperation.

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14. How do structural factors impact social mobility?

Structural factors significantly influence opportunities for social mobility. These include education, economic conditions, caste, class, gender, and government policies.

People born into wealthy families often have better access to quality education and employment opportunities, while disadvantaged groups face barriers. In India, caste inequalities continue to affect occupational mobility and social status.

Gender discrimination may limit women's mobility, whereas affirmative action and welfare schemes can enhance opportunities for marginalized groups. Thus, social mobility is shaped not only by individual effort but also by social structures.

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15. Summarize the Characteristics of Community

A community is a group of people living in a particular geographical area and sharing common life. Major characteristics include:

1. **Common Territory** – Members live in a specific locality.
2. **We-feeling** – Strong sense of belongingness and unity.
3. **Common Culture** – Shared customs, traditions, and values.
4. **Social Interaction** – Regular interaction among members.
5. **Permanence** – Communities usually exist for a long period.
6. **Self-sufficiency** – Members cooperate to satisfy common needs.

Examples include village communities and tribal communities.

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16. Critically Assess the Role of Media in Reinforcing Gender Roles

Media plays a major role in shaping ideas about masculinity and femininity. Television, films, advertisements, and social media often portray stereotypical gender roles.

Women are frequently represented as emotional, dependent, or concerned with beauty, while men are portrayed as strong and dominant. Such portrayals reinforce patriarchal attitudes and unequal gender expectations.

Advertisements often associate women with household work and men with leadership positions. This influences children's perceptions from an early age.

However, media can also challenge stereotypes by promoting women's empowerment, gender equality, and diverse identities. Therefore, media has both reinforcing and transformative roles in relation to gender.

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17. Explain How Peer Groups Impact Adolescent Socialization

Peer groups are important agents of socialization during adolescence. Adolescents spend considerable time with friends and companions of similar age.

Peer groups influence behaviour, language, dressing style, attitudes, and interests. They help adolescents develop self-identity, independence, confidence, and social skills.

Positive peer influence can encourage academic achievement and healthy behaviour, while negative peer pressure may lead to deviance, substance abuse, or risky behaviour.

Thus, peer groups play a significant role in personality development and social adjustment.

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18. Explain How Differential Association Theory Interprets Deviance

Differential Association Theory was developed by Edwin H. Sutherland. According to the theory, deviant behaviour is learned through interaction with others.

Individuals learn techniques, motives, values, and attitudes favourable to deviance from intimate groups such as friends or peer groups. When people are exposed more to definitions supporting deviance than opposing it, they are more likely to engage in deviant acts.

For example, a teenager may learn criminal behaviour from delinquent peers. Therefore, deviance is not inherited but socially learned.

Part C – Long Essay

(Answer any 1 – 10 marks)

19. Elucidate the Role of Intersectionality in Understanding Gender Inequality

Intersectionality is a concept developed mainly by Kimberlé Crenshaw to explain how different forms of inequality interact and overlap. Gender inequality cannot be understood in isolation because women experience discrimination differently based on caste, class, race, religion, ethnicity, sexuality, and disability.

For example, upper-class women and poor women face different social realities. Similarly, Dalit women in India experience both caste discrimination and gender oppression simultaneously. Thus, intersectionality highlights multiple and interconnected forms of disadvantage.

Key Features of Intersectionality

1. **Multiple Identities** – Individuals possess several social identities at the same time.
2. **Interconnected Oppression** – Systems like patriarchy, casteism, racism, and class inequality operate together.
3. **Context-Specific Experiences** – Women's experiences vary across cultures and societies.

Importance in Understanding Gender Inequality

- Explains why all women do not experience oppression equally.
- Draws attention to marginalized women often ignored in mainstream feminism.
- Helps policymakers design inclusive welfare programmes.
- Promotes social justice and equality.

Examples

- Rural women may lack access to education and healthcare.
- Tribal women face economic exploitation and social exclusion.
- Muslim women may face both religious discrimination and patriarchy.

Criticism

Some critics argue that intersectionality becomes too broad and difficult to apply practically. However, it remains an important framework for understanding complex social inequalities.

Conclusion

Intersectionality provides a deeper and more inclusive understanding of gender inequality by recognizing that oppression is multidimensional. It helps sociologists analyse how social structures combine to shape unequal life experiences.

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20. Discuss the Various Strategies Individuals and Social Groups Employ to Manage Role Strain and Role Conflict

Role strain occurs when a person faces difficulties in fulfilling multiple expectations associated with a single role. Role conflict occurs when expectations from different roles clash with each other.

For example, a working mother may experience conflict between professional duties and family responsibilities.

Strategies to Manage Role Strain and Role Conflict

1. Role Prioritization

Individuals give importance to one role over another depending on circumstances. For example, during examinations a student may reduce social activities.

2. Time Management

Proper scheduling and division of responsibilities help balance multiple roles effectively.

3. Role Segregation

People separate roles according to place and time. For instance, professional responsibilities are kept separate from family life.

4. Seeking Support

Family members, friends, colleagues, and institutions provide emotional and practical support in managing roles.

5. Delegation of Responsibilities

Some responsibilities are shared or delegated to others to reduce pressure.

6. Social Adjustment and Negotiation

Individuals negotiate expectations with others to reduce conflict and stress.

7. Institutional Support

Flexible work arrangements, childcare facilities, and counselling services help individuals manage conflicting roles.

Role of Social Groups

Social groups such as family, workplace, peer groups, and community organizations provide guidance, emotional support, and cooperation in handling role pressures.

Consequences if Unmanaged

Failure to manage role strain and conflict may result in stress, anxiety, reduced efficiency, and social isolation.

Conclusion

Role strain and role conflict are common in modern complex societies. Effective coping strategies and supportive social institutions help individuals maintain balance and social stability.